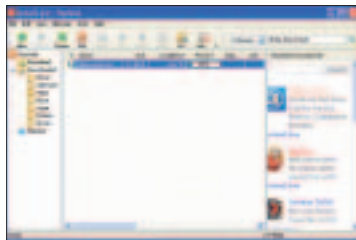
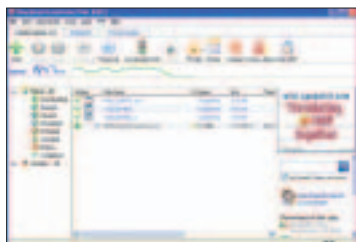




Orbit Downloader – one of the simpler but efficient Mail clients



FlashGet – Improved features to offer



Download Accelerator Plus – With Internet browser and FTP browser attached tabs

tuate but overall it was the same as the others.

What has not changed with DAP are those very irritating pop-up ads that know not when to stop.

DAP has an upload button which leads to FileFlyer.com in an Internet browser tab. It still has the option of purchasing the Premium version which adds a few features like ZIP file previews, Multimedia file previews. These features are still not as good as IDA. If you really want to pay for a Download Manager we would suggest to pay for IDA. DAP may have ruled in the old days but it seems it cannot cope up with the young guns of this era.

DAP used a maximum of 12.5 MB of RAM when downloading the test file.

Orbit Downloader 2.7.8

Orbit Downloader is another freeware with a very simplistic approach. It does not have all the features FDM has. It does not have BitTorrent support, FTP support or a video converter, but is one of the best Flash video grabbers we have come across. When you install the software on to your PC it integrates itself with your Web browser. On visiting a Web site like YouTube, after restarting your browser, you will get a small little button when you drag your mouse over the video which says 'Get it'. On clicking, the download of the video starts directly, eliminating the entire process of copy-pasting a URL which is the case with FDM. There is no video converter or preview feature available for the download though.

The Scheduler is on par with FDM and looks almost identical. Orbit Downloader also has a filter system like IDA does in which you can set the file types that are allowed or not.

Even though Orbit Downloader has fewer features, it is still a good option to

use, as the GUI is very user friendly.

Orbit Downloader is the best when it comes to memory usage. A maximum of 3.5 MB of RAM was used while downloading the test file. The download speeds did fluctuate on the higher side but the outcome was the same as the others

FlashGet 1.9.6

FlashGet is another download manager that has been around for quite awhile now. FlashGet used to be shareware, but is now free. This Download Manager has actually grown with time unlike DAP. It has additional features like Categorized Download, BT protocol support, Scheduler and even a good monitoring filter.

It also has a Site Manager which basically functions also as an FTP explorer. The Site Manager also lets you view all the elements of a Web page.

The scheduler of FlashGet is equal in function as compared to the others we have tested. There are sound alerts which indicate when the download has finished.

FlashGet does have a column to the right which has a software search bar and their recommended software downloads. But these do not interfere with your downloads neither do they trouble you as a pop-up.

There are 2 versions of FlashGet available for download from their Web sites. The users who are used to the older version have the choice to download that and use it.

FlashGet used the most amount of RAM. It hit a maximum of 31.5 MB when we downloaded the test file.

All-in-all, after narrowing down to the best five Download Managers and testing them over and over again, we leave you with these last words. If you are looking for your download manager to have a lot of features then we would suggest the use

of Free Download Manager as overall it proved to be the best among the lot. If for some reason you just need to spend money, get yourself Internet Download Accelerator, which is a good choice, but still cannot compete with FDM. If you do not need all the features that FDM has to offer and want to go solely for performance, then Orbit Downloader is your best bet. In all honesty, if you're not using Free Download Manager, give it a try, it's available for free and is already in our Essentials section!

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Features At A Glance

	Free Download Manager 2.5	IDA 5.6	Orbit Downloader 2.7.8	FlashGet 1.9.6	Download Accelerator Plus 5.6
Memory Usage	14.5MB	20.6MB	3.5MB	31.5MB	12.5MB
Resume Support	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Prioritized Downloads	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Categorized Downloads	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Mirror Searches	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Bandwidth Allocation	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Browser Plug-in	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Scheduler	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓
Flash Video Download	✓	✓	✓	✓	X
BT protocol support	✓	X	X	✓	X
Remote Access	✓	X	X	X	X